PARTNERS *of the* AMERICAS

Connect • Serve • Change Lives

2015 Administrative Guide

Last Revised December 2014.

This manual has been prepared to help you become acquainted with Partners' procedures and administrative procedures, and to answer questions common to new and continuing employees. Feel free to ask for any additional information from your supervisor or from the Finance Office.

Periodic revisions are expected. Questions and suggestions are welcome and should be provided to the Finance and Administration Office. Employees are free to ask about interpretations or to suggest changes at any time. Partners' reserves the right to revise any procedure or guideline described in this document without notice.

Thank you!

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Travel Related

Staff Travel Guidelines

Following are definitions and requirements to be observed by Partners' staff (and in many cases by consultants and Board members working on special assignments) traveling under Partners direction and funding.

Allowable expenses and reimbursement maximums

Partners' travel expense reimbursement policy is based upon reimbursement for actual expenses with a ceiling on such expenses as defined by the per diem rates for the US Government. Though Partners uses these per diem rates to define the maximum reimbursement ceiling, Partners only reimburses for actual expenses. Furthermore, only allowable expenses are reimbursable. No later than 30 days following a trip, a Reimbursement Report should be prepared and submitted to the Finance Office. The Finance Office will not accept reimbursement requests made after 30 days unless approved by Senior Management.

Allowable costs and rates are based on US Government allowances. Updated information regarding rates is available via the web:

- Domestic per diem rates (www.gsa.gov/HP_01Trvl_perdiem)
- Foreign per diem rates (http://aoprals.state.gov/web920/per_diem.asp)

The published per diem rates are composed of two parts:

- Lodging – included in this group are room charges and taxes. Partners will recognize and reimburse lodging costs based on actual expenses, up to the maximum indicated by the accepted per diem rates.
- Meals and incidentals – Partners will pay or reimburse meals and incidental expenses based on the maximum rates established by the accepted per diem rates.

Allowable expenses that may be submitted for reimbursement under the ceiling described above are all reasonable costs which are essential and directly related to the objectives of the grant and/or the main purpose of the trip. Included in the category are costs such as transportation, visas, immunizations, food, lodging, laundry and dry cleaning, reproduction of materials, communications and other allowable expenses as defined by OMB circulars. Allowable expenses are also limited to the conditions established on grants and agreements with funding agencies sponsoring the trip.

Expense reports can be found on the J: Drive at J:\Administration - Finance\FORMS.

Requesting authorization

Staff considering a trip should discuss it with his/her supervisor as to the need for the trip, activities to be conducted, funding for related costs, expectations, etc. (Partners' President will notify the Board about his/her travel plans). Subsequently, the following documentation must be prepared:

- Travel Authorization form (generated using Partners' database)
- Scope of Work (concise and simple).
- Itinerary (travel agent's sheet or equivalent), contact information while travelling, emergency contact, and delegation of duties.

The above-indicated documents should be reviewed and approved by the individual's supervisor. Additionally, the supervisor granting the approval for the trip must ensure that proper procedures related to travel notification/approvals from funding agencies are followed. All staff trips should be entered into the Staff Calendar in Outlook.

Expense and trip reports

No later than 30 days following a trip, a Trip Report should be prepared and submitted to the Finance Office. This report should include the following:

- An Activities Report, indicating the activities conducted during the trip, follow-up plans, partnership update and other information potentially useful to other Partners' staff. This report should be saved on the computer network (J:\Administration - Finance\Staff Trip Reports) and a notice should be sent to all interested staff informing them that the report has been saved in the appropriate folder and available to them.
- An Expense Report, this report should include all related documents (copy of the Travel Authorization, Scope of Work, Itinerary, Activities Report and Expense Report). Each trip should be reported separately. The Finance Office will be responsible for filing and safekeeping of Trip Reports (these documents will be in the Finance Office or in storage for three years). Documentation or support is required for all reimbursable costs of $25 or more. Additionally, staff submitting a Travel Expense report should provide evidence of the exchange rate during the period of travel (a hotel or bank receipt showing a conversion of currency may be a convenient way of satisfying this requirement.) All Expense Reports for the year must be submitted by the end of the calendar year. Failure to comply will be reflected on your Performance Review.

Travel advances

Staff travel advances can be requested before a trip. The request can be up to a maximum of 80% of the US Government Per Diem rate for the location to which you are traveling. The check request must be accompanied by a signed Travel Authorization. Please submit check requests two weeks before departure date to ensure adequate processing time. All advances should be cleared 30 days from the issued check date.

Expenses which will be reimbursed by other organizations

Please send an email notifying the Finance Office of:

- Date of trip
- Specific expenses that will be reimbursed
- Is there a fee that POA will charge, or not
- Billing instructions including what kind of back up needs to be provided

The Finance Office will assist with submission of invoices to the organizations for payment.

Absences

Further information about procedures for staff while they are out of the office on travel can be found in the Staff & Employment section of this guide.

Personal travel

If, for personal reasons, the traveler wishes to go to places other than those on the authorized Partners itinerary, he/she may book and must pay for those reservations and additional costs directly through our travel consultants by major credit card only. Appropriate documentation showing the additional costs should be kept on file.

Fly America Act

All US government-funded Partners travel will comply with the Fly America Act, which requires that all travel and shipments must be made on U.S. flag carriers to the extent services by such carriers is available. More information can be found under J:\Administration - Finance\ADMINISTRATIVE GUIDE.

Premiere Travel

Travel arrangements for approved travelers are made through our travel agency, Premiere Travel. Travel must be detailed and approved with a Travel Authorization form, which are generated using the Partners database (more information on the database can be found in the "Computer Support" section of this guide). Either of our main contacts can assist with travel plans, although each unit usually has one representative they work with on a regular basis.

- Pilar Sindler Hill, psindler@premieretravel.com

  202-962-8514 (1-800-328-8463)

- Melissa Backenstow, melissa@premieretravel.com

  703-287-8985 (1-800-458-8670 x8985)

Staff are also free to contact Premiere Travel's CEO with questions, concerns, or for assistance for more complicated requests such as large groups or conference planning.

- Robert Hakim, robert@premieretravel.com

  703-287-8997 (1-800-458-8670)

Staff & Employment

Please see the Employee Manual for official policies regarding employment, leave, holidays, benefits, and other Human Resources issues.

Communicating Absences

All time out of the office must be marked on the Staff Calendar folder in Outlook with as much advance notice as possible. Staff members may email all staff about their travel plans if there is the possibility their time there might benefit other programs or units. However, emails to all staff about other absences are usually not necessary and should be kept to a minimum.

Updating voicemail

When staff are out of the office for more than a day, it is recommended that they set up their outgoing voicemail message so that people are informed that they are out of the office and when are they coming back, and possibly who will be covering for them during that time. In the "greetings" menu of your voicemail you have the option to record and switch to an "alternate" out-of-office message, then you can easily switch back when you return to the office.

Automatic reply

When staff are out of the office for more than a day, it is recommended that they set up an "automatic reply" on their email so that people are informed that they are out of the office, when are they coming back and who they should contact in case of an urgent issue. This can be configured in Outlook under the "File Menu" in the "Automatic Replies (Out of Office)" section.

Staff calendar

Whenever a staff member will be out of the office, it must be indicated on the Staff Calendar in Outlook along with information regarding times/dates and the reason for being out of the office (such as trip details, AL – Annual Leave, SL – Sick Leave, WFH – Work From Home, etc.). Details beyond that are not necessary for personal leave. However, additional information is required when the absence is due to business-related meetings, activities or trips.

When indicating that you'll be out of the office for travel, write the complete name of the event you're attending in the *subject* header. Use the *body* of the calendar note to provide additional information (even if only preliminary) on your activities or needs that could be helpful to either Program Development or Communications. For example:

- *Subject*: "Michelle in Guatemala for II Summit of Indigenous Journalists"

  Body: "Meeting with Shakira's people—what materials do I need to have on hand?"

If you are traveling to multiple locations, please note the change of location on the staff calendar, as well as if you are attending additional events using the same procedure as above.

Please indicate all possible travel on the Staff Calendar as early as possible. The Communications Unit maintains an editorial calendar that runs three to six months out, and in some cases more, so to guarantee that your needs can be covered we need to know about travel requiring communications support as early as possible

If you are planning a Partners event, please indicate the dates of the event on the Staff Calendar as early as possible. If your program participants are traveling/organizing their own events and you require communications support, please also indicate on Staff Calendar. For example:

- *Subject*: "Maria Gomez- CC Fellow- To International Water Conference Asuncion, PY"

  Body: "Maria needs a press release prior to the event. She also wants to speak to press in Asuncion about water rights."

Even if you are only out of the office in Washington, DC to attend an event, please indicate using the same procedures as above.

Late arrivals

Please be sure to alert your supervisor if you will be arriving more than 30 minutes late. Late arrivals generally do not need to be communicated to all staff.

Hiring of New Staff and/or Consultants

Staff

Information regarding the hiring process and other applicable documents can be found under J:\Administration - Finance\HR HANDBOOK\Pre-Employment

Consultants

Consultants (including interns) are hired based on specific scopes of work that are to be prepared by their supervisor. All contracts need to include:

- Scope of work
- Terms of payment and compensation rate
- Performance period

- Name of supervisor

The Finance Office has templates available for consultant contracts on the J: Drive at J:\Administration - Finance\CONSULTANTS and intern contracts at J:\Administration - Finance\INTERNS. Once a contract has been prepared, it must be presented to CFO/VP of Operations for approval prior to being signed by the consultant or intern.

Consultants and interns do not accrue benefits and they are responsible for their own taxes regardless of citizenship. Partners provides the form 1099 at the end of the year for US-based payees. Consultants and interns are paid upon presentation of all reports, products and deliverables stated on their agreements. All travel expenses are verified and supported by backups and follow all staff travel policies. To issue a payment to a consultant or intern, a check or wire transfer request is to be prepared with all documentation listed above, and signed by a supervisor.

New Staff Orientation

All staff receive a new staff orientation during their first days at Partners. It is the responsibility of the supervisor, in coordination with the Finance Office, to ensure that the new staff member is adequately briefed by other staff.

The purpose of the orientation is first, to brief new employees on our activities and responsibilities so they can become as comfortable and productive as possible, as rapidly as possible; and second, to build from the start the sort of lateral communication across our organization that creates a healthy work environment and makes the whole greater than the sum of the parts.

The orientation has several elements.

- Official processing of employee (payroll, benefits, etc.) by the Finance & Administration Office and an overview of employee manual, policies and procedures
- Detailed introduction by the supervisor, focused on the job and its relationship to the organization
- Meetings between the new employee and the President
- Meeting with each Program or Unit Director to be informed about each program's mission, procedures, and possible relationships to the new employee's work
- Meeting with the Finance & Administration Office to explain policies and procedures pertinent to the new staff member's grant or unit, budget, etc.
- Employee initiative, to fill in holes and specific needs

For more information regarding the orientation and on-boarding process contact the Finance & Administration Office.

Staff Development

Partners encourages employees to attend presentations, workshops, or discussions on topics related to their professional interests as much as possible. Staying professionally current is a high priority. Financial support for training, conferences, coursework, and other forms of capacity-building that require a paid fee and/or time off from work, will be considered on an individual basis, guided by the following three categories:

1. Skills that are integrally involved in the most important responsibilities of the employee's position.
2. Skills that are involved in some aspects of the employee's position, but are not wholly and/or directly related to the most important.
3. Training, important for general development, but with no direct involvement in the employee's position.

Approval for training in Category 1 generally provides for full reimbursement, training in Category 2 generally for half, and in Category 3 by discretion.

Reimbursement in all three categories is conditional upon available program and administrative resources. When possible, training for Categories 1 and 2 should be paid for by individual programs. When not possible, such training should draw on the Partners Professional Development administrative budget. Category 3 will most likely depend on the Professional Development budget. Reimbursement in any category should be recommended by the relevant supervisor or grant manager, and approved by the Finance & Administration Office or the President.

Performance Evaluation

Good evaluations are multi-dimensional. Employees should have a self-evaluation in mind, and complete a form themselves. Good evaluations also include supervisor consultations with others who know the employee's work, including people in other offices or even outside Partners. This "360 degree" evaluation depends upon both the supervisor's initiative in seeking additional feedback, and proactive efforts of staff to provide such feedback to appropriate supervisors. The process should include all staff, from the President to every member at HQ and field offices.

The supervisor does the evaluation taking these various inputs into account to supplement his or her own perceptions. The supervisor should also seek feedback from the person being evaluated. Once the process is completed, an overall performance level is given and the form is signed by the employee and the supervisor. The supervisor submits these to the respective Vice President or directly to President, when applicable. The President submits these to the Finance and Administration Office within ten (10) working days for processing. Once the forms are processed, a copy of the final form can be requested from the Finance & Administration Office.

For official policies regarding performance reviews and salary increases, please consult the Employee Manual or contact the Finance & Administration Office.

Financial

Grant Numbers and Line Items

Partners assigns grant numbers to all programs depending on the type of activity. These are generally designated as follows, with some exceptions.

- 90s – Administration
- 100s – Civil Society
- 200s – Education and Culture (Exchanges)
- 300s – Training
- 400s – Social and Economic Development
- 500s – Health
- 600s – Agriculture and Environment

Check Requests

Check requests are used for payments via check issued from the Finance Office. A copy of this form can be found on the J: Drive at J:\Administration - Finance\FORMS, Requests, Templates. Please include all necessary back up documentation when requesting a check.

- Write the "Payable To" name of the person or organization as you would like it to appear on the check.
- If the address you are providing is new or different than the last time a check was requested for this vendor, please bring it to our attention so the adjustment can be made in our system prior to printing the check.
- The coding section should be completed with assistance from your supervisor, as it directly affects the program or grant's budget. A list of possible Activities and Line Items can be found on the second tab of the spreadsheet, although not every code is valid for event grant or unit.
- Include a Customer Reference or Account Number, Invoice Number and Invoice Date if applicable.
- Whatever you write in the "Check Memo" section will appear on the check, and also as a description in our system and on reports. Because that is limited to a certain number of characters, you can provide more detailed information for the files in the space below.
- Please mark whether you would like the Finance Office to mail the check on your behalf, or whether it should be delivered to a staff member's mailbox after printing. If nothing is indicated, the check will be mailed.
- Person requesting and supervisor approval are necessary for payment.
- Checks over $10,000 require two authorized signatories to be in the office.

Completed requests should be left in the appropriate bin in the Finance Office. Check requests are due by 5:00pm Monday for issuance that week.

Wire Transfers

Wire transfers can be requested when the payee cannot receive the funds via check. Wire transfer requests can be found on the J: Drive at J:\Administration - Finance\FORMS & Templates. Please include all necessary back up documentation with your request.

The form allows you to provide the basic bank information necessary for most wires, but when sending a wire transfer to a new payee it is better for the payee to request instructions from their bank. Every country and sometimes banks have different requirements, and wires sent with bad information are not always returned to Partners.

- Write the "Payable To" name of the person or organization as it appears on their bank account.
- US Banks at a minimum require an ABA routing number and the account number. ABA numbers for wire transfers are often different than the routing number printed on checks, so the payee they should consult with their bank to confirm. They should also ask if any fees will be deducted, many US banks now charge customers for incoming wire transfers.
- International Banks at a minimum require the SWIFT code (all letters) and the account number. Many countries require more information, which is why it is best to have the payee ask their bank for instructions. Almost all international wires will have fees deducted by the recipient's bank, but the amounts can vary widely, so they should ask their bank before the payment is made.

- If Partners has sent a wire to a particular payee before, we may have saved their information for future wires. It is important to bring it to our attention if any bank information has changed from a previous request.
- The coding section should be completed with assistance from your supervisor, as it directly affects the program or grant's budget. A list of possible Activities and Line Items can be found on the second tab of the spreadsheet, although not every code is valid for event grant or unit.
- Include an Invoice Number and Invoice Date if applicable.
- Whatever you write in the "Memo" section will be included when the wire transfer is processed, and also as a description in our system and on reports. Because that is limited to a certain number of characters, you can provide more detailed information for the files in the space below.
- Please let the Finance Office know who should be alerted once payment is complete, and provide their email address if necessary.
- Person requesting and supervisor approval are necessary for payment.

Since wire transfers take funds immediately from our bank account, we are unable to make wire transfer payments on a regular schedule. Transfers under $5,000 will generally be completed within a few days, while larger transfers could take up to a week. Funds may not arrive immediately in the recipient's account, especially when transfers are made internationally. Please allow plenty of time for processing.

Wires via affiliate organizations

In some countries it is not always possible for us to make wire transfers directly to individuals' or even organizational accounts. Brazil is the most common example, but other countries such as Bolivia and Colombia may also be affected. In these cases, wire transfers will be sent to our partner organization in those countries, and they will make the payment on our behalf.

In these cases, submit a wire transfer request as usual. If the transfer cannot be made directly to the payee, the Finance Office will ask you to provide the payee's contact information so it can be forwarded to the appropriate person in the local office. These transfers can take much longer than ones made directly from our office, please allow for a long processing time.

American Express, VISA and Corporate Cards

Staff that travel frequently may have American Express and/or VISA cards issued in their names. The use of the cards is for business use only and all expenses should be presented to the Finance & Administration Office within thirty (30) days of receiving the monthly statement.

Partners benefits from the use of corporate cards by accumulating points and rebates. For information about redeeming rewards or miles, speak with the Finance & Administration Office.

Procurement Policies and Procedures

Partners of the Americas acquires goods and services through various funds, including core and grant and contract funds. It is the policy of Partners to follow the requirements of OMB Circular 110 regarding the procurement of goods and services especially for U.S. government-funded projects. The nature of grants with the U.S. government and most other donors means that all costs incurred may eventually be audited by public accountants or the Inspector General's office. It is therefore essential to negotiate the most economical conditions for all purchases. Procurement will be made with complete impartiality based strictly on the merits of a supplier's proposal and applicable related considerations such as delivery, quantity, after-sale service, etc.

The Finance & Administration Office is responsible for reviewing all bids over $1,000 and must ensure funds are available for purchases. All bids and purchase documents must be saved in the Finance Office for future audits. It is the policy of Partners of the Americas to procure only those items which are required to fulfill the objectives of grants and contracts, or those which are genuinely needed by the organization to meet its mission.

At least three bids must be obtained for all purchases over $1,000, except for services such as legal, accounting and temporary help. The Finance & Administration Office is responsible for reviewing all bids with the appropriate Program Director before the authorization is made for the purchases.

Petty Cash

The Finance & Administration Office manages a small petty cash fund which is used to reimburse or advance for expenses under $25. Receipts and a Petty Cash slip are required.

Communications

All information covered below is for general reference only. For detailed information on Partners' branding guidelines and communications policies, please reference the Communications Manual.

Partners Logos

Part of raising the visibility of Partners (which is directly linked to funding) is providing a consistent, high quality look. In keeping with this objective, branding experts recommend that we present our logo in a consistent fashion – this helps "brand" Partners in people's minds.

The Partners' Logo can be found in J:\External Communications and Outreach\Branding and Image. There are a few different logos for different situations, please consult with the Communications unit before including any logos in your publications or external communications. Here are some rules of thumb to keep in mind when using the logo:

- Should be displayed prominently (so that it is not hard to find) on all publications
- Should remain consistent – keep the mark consistent with the logotype

External Communication & Publications

Major external communication and printed publications must be reviewed by the Communications team before dissemination. The team will review for clarity of message and design considerations related to placement of logo and recognition of donors/sponsors. This will be done as expeditiously as possible, however please plan for a couple of revisions in your production process. It is also recommended to consult first with the Communications team to get some input up-front.

News releases

All programs are encouraged to periodically communicate their achievements and news (i.e. when launching a program, when significant achievements or events take place, final results, etc.). The Communications team is available to provide guidelines and suggestions. Program budgets should cover translation and printing costs whenever possible.

Stored publications

Partners stores and displays a variety of publications in the kitchen and attic. These include Partners' annual report, maps, folders, one-pagers, and event information. Any restrictions on the use of these items will be noted in the area they are stored in.

Web

Partners' website is http://www.partners.net. Take a look at the site and familiarize yourself with its contents. All teams and programs are responsible for maintaining current information on their programs in all relevant languages in consultation with the Communications team.

Business Cards

Please contact the Communications team to order or replenish Business Cards.

Pins

Partners has pins that are orange with the Partners logo. The price varies, they are usually sold at cost to volunteers and members. Please see the Communications Unit regarding payment for pins. Programs may have their own promotional merchandise more specific to their grant, which is produced in coordination with the Communications team.

Office & Equipment

Phones

The main phone number for Partners is (202) 628-3300 or Toll-Free (800) 322-7844.

Most staff direct lines are 202-637-6XXX, the last three digits being the person's extension (some intern extensions do not have a direct dial number). We did run out of 202-637-6XXX phone numbers so now all new phone numbers are (202)524-6XXX. The phone display will say which extension it is currently programmed for and the name associated with that extension.

Our phones use a Voice over IP (VoIP) system. There is an accompanying online portal called OfficeSuite. You can access our OfficeSuite portal by going to this web address:
https://officesuite2.broadviewnet.net/webadmin/login/202633AAAB

Quick start guides with a lot of useful information regarding the phones, online portal and voicemail system can be found under J:\Administration - Finance\ADMINISTRATIVE GUIDE\Phone Quick Start Guides. Many phone settings can be configured through the OfficeSuite portal such as call forwarding, call coverage, memory keys, etc.

Logging in / out of phones

To "log into" a phone, press the button (soft key) next to "ACTIVATE" on the phone's screen. Enter your extension number and pin, and press the "ENTER" soft key. To "log out" of a phone, press the following soft keys: "MENU" "LOGOUT" >"YES".

Outgoing calls

To make a call, lift the handset or press the key for the speakerphone.

- To call an internal extension, simply dial the 3-digit number.
- For domestic calls, dial **9 + 1 + Area Code + Phone Number** (even for 202 numbers).
- To call internationally, dial **9 + 011 + Country Code + Phone Number**. You have been assigned an international calling code which you will need to enter upon placing the call. Contact the Administration Officer if you need to request an international calling code.

Incoming calls

When you receive a call, it will say under the caller ID information "For: ___" to indicate if the call is to your direct line, your department group, the main line, etc. To change the ring tones for different types of calls, log into OfficeSuite go to "My Phone" → "Configure Ring Tones."

Main line

All interns, program and unit officers share the responsibility of answering the main line and lobby intercom line, and then assisting or directing callers. The main line and intercom line do not ring on everyone's phone, only those responsible for answering it.

Transferring calls

To transfer, while on a call, press the "Transfer/Confere" soft key or the button on the phone. Then enter the person's or group's 3-digit extension. The call will transfer when you hang up the receiver, so you can stay on the line and let the person know who is calling or simply hang up after you dial the extension.

Unlocking the elevator

Guests/Visitors using the intercom located outside of your main doors will appear as "**Douglas Dev**" on the phone. **To unlock the main doors press " 9 " on the phone keypad while on the intercom call.**

Be sure to ask who they are coming to visit at Partners before granting access. Also, let them know that they will have access to the elevator upon entering and to go directly to the 7th or 4th Floor.

Conference calls

Conference or three-way calls can be initiated once you are already on a call. Ask the current caller to hold, then press the "Transfer/Confere" soft key or the button on the phone. Dial 91 / 9011 + the number for the second caller. Once the second call is answered, press the "Transfer/Confere" key or button again to join the calls.

For conference calls requiring a larger number of participants, staff should utilize their InterCall Reservationless Plus account. Each employee was assigned a username upon employment. If you are in need of a user account please contact the Administration Officer.

Voicemail

To access your voicemail, press the button on your phone. Unless you are otherwise instructed, the default pin number is 1234. When you set up your mailbox for the first time it will prompt you to change it to something more personal.

Your voicemail greeting should say something along these lines: "*Hello – this is (name) (title or department) at Partners of the Americas. I'm either on the phone or away from my desk. Please leave your message at the sound of the tone and I'll return your call as soon as possible. If you need immediate assistance, press zero for an operator*."

Offsite voicemail access

When you're out of the office and you want to hear your messages by phone, call the main line 202-628-3300. Once the greeting begins, press * and the voice prompts will walk you through the steps. To access your voicemail online, visit https://voicemail.broadviewnet.com/Default.aspx?UserName. In the "Telephone Number" field enter our main number (2026283300), and then enter your extension and password (voicemail pin number).

There is also a Broadview OfficeSuite voicemail app available for iPhone and Android (search “OfficeSuite Voicemail” in the app store).

Office Supplies Purchases

Partners participates in the Staples Advantage program which is completely online and makes ordering supplies quick and hassle-free. Upon employment, you will receive a welcome email that will provide you with your log in credentials. You may place orders at your convenience, however, all orders must be approved by the Finance & Administration Office.

Postage Meter

In the kitchen there is a Postage Meter machine which can weigh and calculate postage, then print the postage on envelopes or labels. Instructions can be found next to the machine. You must choose the grant or unit to be charged for the postage before using the machine.

Printers & Copiers

Partners has the following printers and copiers available:

- Ricoh 2352-4th Floor - B&W, Copy and Scan
- Ricoh C6501- 7th Floor (North) – B&W, Color, Copy, Fax and Scan
- Ricoh C4503- 7th Floor (South) – B&W, Color, Copy and Scan

Please contact mindSHIFT Technologies at 877-581-6508 to set up the laser printer closest to your desk.

For supplied or repair requests please contact Centric Business Solutions at 877-902-7999. The help desk representative will ask you for the equipment ID (listed below) in order to process supply or repair requests. Please alert the Finance & Administration Office for further assistance if needed.

- Ricoh 2352 ID #54371
- Ricoh C6501 ID#51434
- Ricoh C4503 ID#54370

Printer settings

Because Partners has supply and maintenance agreements with Centric/Ricoh, we pay on a per-page basis. Additional costs for color are charged based on the amount of color used on the page. We recommend using the “Green” settings as your default printer settings, which is B&W and 2-sided printing. You can always override these settings before an individual print job if needed.

Sending faxes

To send a fax from the RicohC6501 machine, select the “Fax” option on the home screen and type in the recipient’s number before placing the documents in the scanning tray. Press the “Start” button to scan and fax the document.

Scanning

All three Ricoh copiers have the scanning functionality. On any machine, select the “Email” option on the home screen. Either search for your name in the address book or type your email address in the “To:” field. Set your scanning options, then press the “Start” button. A .pdf of your scan will be sent to the email addressed indicated.

Computer Support

MindShift is our computer/network support company and provides assistance through remote support (with on-site support when necessary). Contact information and ID number for your machine can be found on the sticker on your monitor or CPU. To access online support at https://support.mindshift.com, you can request a username and password from MindShift.

New users

New Partners user accounts and emails for intern or staff members must be requested by one of Partners' designated Points of Contact for IT matters, do not email MindShift directly with these requests. Requests must be emailed to Peggy Carlson (pcarlson@partners.net) and Horacio Correa (hcorrea@partners.net) with at least 48 hours advance notice. You will need to send them the full name of the staff member and also let them know the computer ID number where they will most likely sit (if you know that information). If the user needs special access, permissions, or if they should be in any particular email groups, please include that in your request.

Guest user

Visitors to our office or anyone who does not have a designated username can log onto a workstation using the "Guest" log-in:

- Username: poa.guest@partners.net
- Password: [password is changed regularly, you can request the most recent password from IT or F&A]

Wireless internet

The Partners office has two WiFi hubs on each side of the office, the name of the network is PAR-Wireless and the access code is: 712f2441227978455c7b44577c

Shared address book(s) and distribution lists

There are several address books or distribution lists available to Partners staff through Outlook. The Global Address list includes all general addresses including staff, board of directors and partnerships. Updates to these lists should be emailed to Peggy Carlson and Horacio Correa.

An email can be distributed to the Partners staff that work in the DC Office by addressing an email to DCStaff@Partners.net. To email the entire Partners staff, including international affiliate organizations, an email can be addressed to AllStaff@Partners.net.

Public and private network drives

The Partners file network is organized by drives. A common J: Drive stores general information by function and is available to all staff. Each staff member has an individual drive to store personal documents (F: Drive) and many units have private shared drives. There is also an R: Drive for all digital images and videos.

J: Drive/J: Read-only drive

Please note all staff have access to a lot of useful documents in the J:\READ ONLY folder, such as current and past staff contact information, field office information, etc.

The Partners Directory is also located on this drive, and is continuously updated by Carmen Sepassi. As we are informed of changes in the chapters officers' mailing address, telephone and fax numbers, and e-mail address if any, they are updated and saved in the folder for easy accessibility. Please let Carmen Sepassi know if you have any corrections, additions, changes, etc. to any of these documents.

Virtual Private Network (VPN)

Partners has a Virtual Private Network (VPN) that allows staff to access private and common network drives from their work laptops from home or while travelling. Instructions for setting this up on your machine can be found under J:\Administration - Finance\ADMINISTRATIVE GUIDE\VPN Instructions.

Database

Partners has a database that stores information regarding volunteers, travel, partnerships, donors, organizations, programs and projects. It is an important tool for Partners and one we hope you will utilize frequently. Contact IT support for assistance setting up and accessing the database on your computer.

Security

New employees and interns should see the Finance & Administration Office to be assigned a building security key fob. The building security key fob is necessary 24 hours a day to access our suites and enter the building at all times. In case of loss the employee will be responsible for covering the cost of its replacement (currently $40).

Elevators

Visitors and deliveries must request access via the intercom located outside of the building's main doors. To unlock the main doors dial "9" on your keypad while on the intercom line. Be sure to meet the visitor or delivery at the elevator, or make sure the appropriate person is going to meet them. This system helps us keep our floor secure since there are limited concierge services in the lobby. Don't be afraid to ask who they are, whom they are here to visit or whom their package is for.

Alarm

Our security alarm system is provided and monitored by Kastle Security Systems. The main security alarm is located in Suite 700 and the reader is adjacent to the reception desk. The alarm will automatically arm and disarm- It will be armed Monday to Friday from 8pm to 8am, and disarmed from 8:01am to 7:59pm Monday to Friday. The security alarm will be armed all day Saturday & Sunday. In addition, Partners Suites located on the 4th Floor have a key reader located outside of the main door entry. Although these readers do not have a sensor tied to a siren, the activity is still monitored by Kastle. Furthermore, only Partners staff has the ability to arm and disarm the security alarm by swiping their key fob on the reader during nonbusiness hours. If the alarm is tripped Kastle will follow the set protocol- Kastle will notify the primary contact (Kristian Vasquez) with a phone call and a follow up email to inquire how to proceed. Kastle will follow the instructions given by the Primary Contact. Should the Primary Contact not be available, Kastle will then contact the secondary and tertiary point of contacts (F&A Team Members). Directors have been given 2 extra key fobs so that at their discretion, they may assign it to their intern or consultant. The Director will be responsible for managing the two extra key fobs. For example, the Director will make sure to give and receive the key fob back from the intern or consultant upon start and ending of employment. Additional keys will not be given, each program may decide to purchase additional key fobs ($40 each) if needed. If Directors are informed that either of their extra key fobs is misplaced, lost, or stolen- the Finance & Administration Office will need to be notified immediately. At which time, a replacement key fob will be ordered and the cost of $40 each will be charged to the program/dept. Please make an important note of the following- key fobs assigned to interns and consultants will have restricted access. They will only have access to our suites during business hours from 8am to 5:30pm Monday to Friday - no weekend access, no exceptions.

Finally, to arm or disarm follow these steps:

To Arm- Swipe your key fob on the reader pad located adjacent to the reception desk. The light will go from green to red. You will have 30 seconds to clear the room.To Disarm- Swipe your key fob on the reader pad located adjacent to the reception desk. The light will go from red to green.

Safety

The health and safety of our Partners family is always our top priority, and everyone can play a part in making the Partners office a comfortable, secure environment. Before our elevators required a key fob to access our suites, we had a few instances of petty theft of personal possessions from employees' offices. There have also been reports of unauthorized persons in the lobby or building after hours, often getting past locked doors and elevators by coercing the cleaning crew or waiting for people to leave which gives them momentary access. While there have never been any major threats to the safety of our staff or office, we believe that vigilance and prevention are the best way to avoid possible dangers.

- If you feel uncomfortable for any reason, don't feel pressured to let someone onto the floor until you have verified that they have a legitimate reason for requesting access.
- When visitors call on the intercom, find out who they are there to meet and alert that person to greet them at the elevator or lobby. If the person they are meeting isn't available to greet them, meet them at the elevators or lobby yourself and accompany them to that person.
- For deliveries, even if it's not for you, go to the elevator to sign for or receive the package. Don't assume the staff near the elevators will always do this.
- If you encounter someone in the lobby, call or find the person they are meeting to confirm the meeting and let that person grant them access. Don't be afraid to say that you they can't ride up with you until that person gives permission.
- If they can't immediately name who they are meeting or why they want access, then it is a good clue that something might be wrong – especially after hours. Once an unauthorized man on the floor, when confronted about his reason for being there, said he was meeting the person on the first nameplate he saw (when in reality that person had left the office for the day).
- If someone is seeking access to another floor, don't get involved. The callbox in front of the building is a good place to direct visitors trying to access other floors.
- If you are working late in the office, check to see if others are here as well. Don't stay in the office late at night or leave by yourself. There is safety and comfort in numbers.
- If you feel unsure, don't get in the elevator or otherwise involve yourself in a situation with someone you don't know. If you find yourself in an uncomfortable situation, try to get away from it and when you are safe, call for help.

Remember that your safety and security should always be the first concern, and it is more important than any item we possess in our office.

Conference Rooms

Partners has a large conference room and small conference room available for meetings. The large conference room located on the 7th Floor and seats approximately 30-40 people, depending on configuration. The small conference room is located on the 4th Floor and seats approximately 15-20 people, depending on configuration. Either room should be

reserved in advance for meeting by signing up through the "Conference Rooms" shared calendar in the Public Folders in Outlook. Anyone is free to use this room at any time but meetings with reservations always have preference.

Staff members with larger offices should leave their offices neat and accessible while out of the office, so that they can be used by other staff for smaller, informal meetings.

Kitchen Duty

As we all use the kitchen at some point, we are all responsible for keeping it clean and organized. All staff will be assigned a week for kitchen duty, which you can trade with another staff member if you will be out of the office. Kitchen duty includes:

- Running the dishwasher at night
- Unloading the dishwasher in the morning
- Generally making sure the kitchen is clean and in order

Everyone is responsible for putting their dirty dishes in dishwasher and cleaning up their own mess on the counter, in the microwave, etc. as well as keeping the refrigerator clean and preventing overcrowding/spoiled food.

Green Initiatives

Partners is always looking for ways to make our office and work more environmentally-conscious. Here are some of our current "Green" initiatives, and we are always open to suggestions of new ways we can reduce our environmental impact.

Email signature

Encourage others to be more thoughtful about their printer usage by adding a line to your signature like this: Please consider the environment before printing this email.

Here is a website that can help walk you through the steps: http://www.ehow.com/how_5420224_insert-environmental-message-outlook-signature.html

Lights

Remember to turn off the lights in your office (if separate from the main lights) before you leave at night. If you are one of the last to leave to the office, help make sure the bathroom, conference room and kitchen lights are turned off. The last person to leave should turn off the main lights at the switch by the elevators before setting the alarm.

Recycle

DC law requires businesses to recycle, and around the office are different bins for trash, paper and other recyclables. Please be conscious of where you toss things, since we or the landlord could be fined if our refuse is not sorted correctly. Therefore, it's also a good idea to mark the bin(s) in your office using one of the three categories (trash, paper, or recyclables), so the cleaning company has no doubts about what to do with the contents.

There is a shredder near the Ricoh C4503 (South Side) printer so you can shred documents with sensitive information before recycling. There is a 10-15 page limit that can be shredded at a time.

Reuse

Keep a bin or folder in your office to save scrap paper for expense reports (to attach receipts), notes, drafts, calculations, etc. Before throwing away a binder, folder, etc. that you no longer need, please remove the papers to be recycled/reused, and place the supplies back in the kitchen for someone else to us.

Set your printing defaults

Please contact mindSHIFT Techonologies to help set up your printer defaults. See the section in “Printers & Copiers” for their contact information.